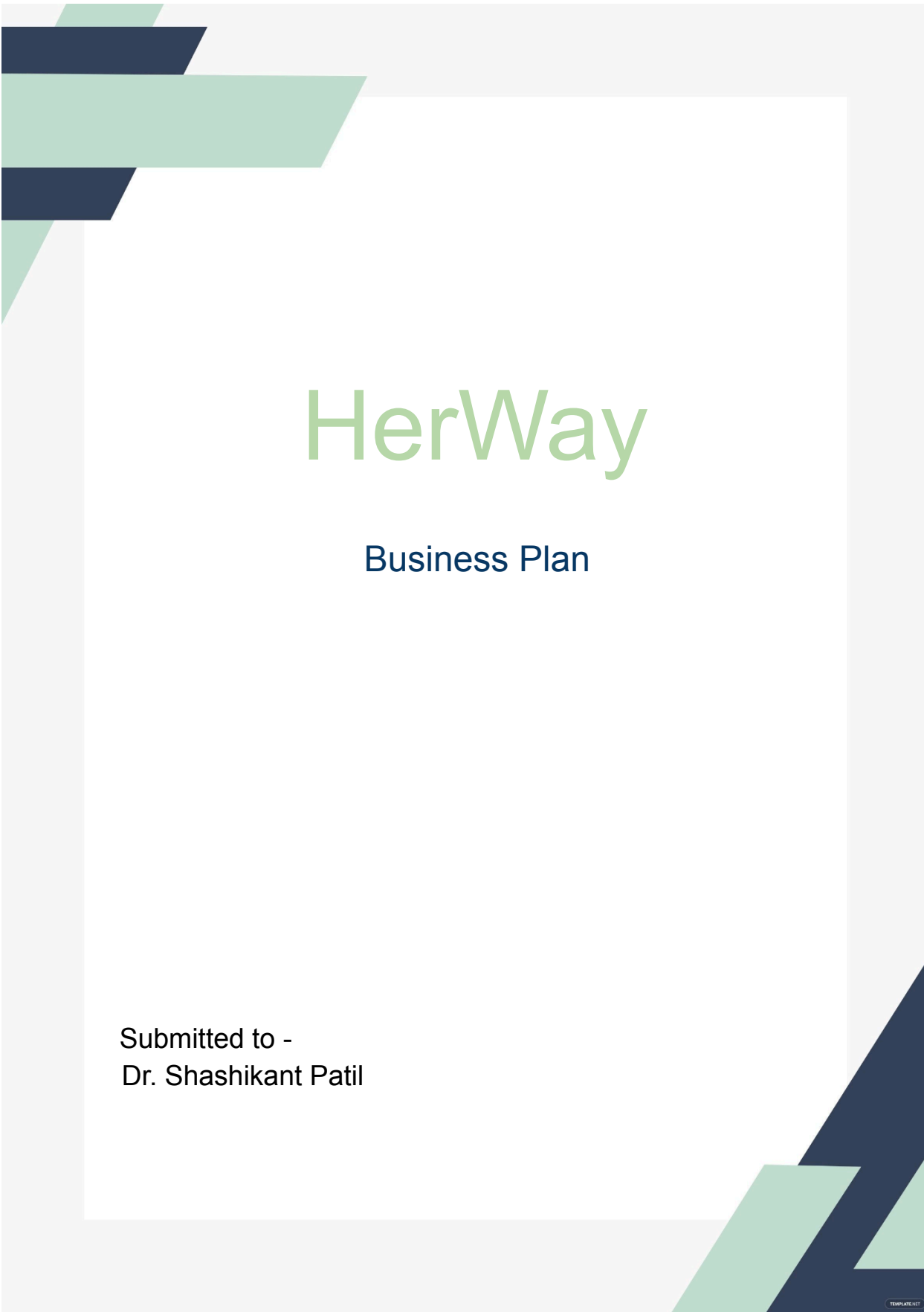




HerWay

Business Plan

Submitted to -
Dr. Shashikant Patil

HerWay is a women-focused ride-hailing platform designed to address two critical challenges in urban mobility: the safety concerns faced by women commuters and the limited access to flexible, higher-paying employment opportunities for women in low-wage occupations. The venture proposes a women-only mobility ecosystem where female passengers are connected exclusively with trained female drivers through a digital platform, ensuring both safety and trust in daily travel.

Unlike conventional ride-hailing services that primarily rely on four-wheel vehicles, HerWay focuses on **two-wheeler ride-hailing** as its core operational model. Two-wheelers provide a practical and cost-effective solution for short-distance urban mobility, particularly in congested cities where traffic and last-mile connectivity are major concerns. This approach also lowers entry barriers for potential drivers, as many women already possess basic two-wheeler riding skills. With structured training programs and licensing support, HerWay aims to transform these existing skills into sustainable income opportunities.

A central component of the HerWay model is **economic empowerment through workforce enablement**. The platform specifically targets women currently employed in low-paying and physically demanding jobs such as domestic work, security services, and cleaning roles. These occupations often involve long working hours with limited financial growth. HerWay offers an alternative pathway by providing training, platform access, and flexible work opportunities that allow women to earn independently while maintaining control over their working hours.

To further reduce financial barriers for new drivers, HerWay intends to collaborate with vehicle manufacturers and financing partners to introduce **two-wheeler leasing programs**. Under this model, women drivers can access vehicles on an affordable lease basis rather than making large upfront purchases. This system enables aspiring drivers to enter the mobility sector without significant financial risk while gradually building income stability.

HerWay also differentiates itself through an **ethical and driver-friendly revenue model**. Instead of charging high commissions on every ride, the platform will operate on a **subscription-based structure**. Drivers will pay a small access fee of ₹500 or complete a minimum threshold of rides (e.g., 30 rides) to maintain active access to the platform. Importantly, the company will take **0% commission on individual rides**, allowing drivers to retain 100% of their earnings. This approach promotes fairness, improves driver satisfaction, and strengthens long-term retention.

The initial target market includes women students, working professionals, and urban commuters who prioritize safety and reliability in transportation services. By focusing on short-distance rides and last-mile connectivity, HerWay aims to serve high-frequency mobility needs in dense urban environments. Early operations will prioritize closed community environments such as university campuses, residential neighborhoods, and institutional clusters to establish trust and operational efficiency before expanding to broader urban areas.

From a financial perspective, HerWay is designed to operate with a **lean and scalable platform model**. Revenue will primarily be generated through driver subscriptions and future institutional

partnerships. Key initial investments will include technology development, driver training programs, vehicle leasing partnerships, safety infrastructure, and community-based outreach. As driver participation increases, the subscription-based model offers predictable recurring revenue while maintaining fair earnings for drivers.

Beyond its commercial potential, HerWay aims to generate measurable social impact. By improving safe mobility for women and creating accessible employment pathways, the platform contributes to broader social goals of gender equality, economic empowerment, and inclusive urban development. The initiative aligns with several United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, particularly **SDG 5 (Gender Equality)**, **SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth)**, and **SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities)**.

In summary, HerWay represents a socially responsible and economically sustainable approach to urban mobility. By integrating safe transportation, workforce development, and ethical platform economics, the venture seeks to create a trusted ecosystem where women can travel safely and work independently. With a clear market need, scalable operational model, and strong social impact potential, HerWay is positioned to redefine women-centered mobility in urban environments.

Below is a **formal Company Description section for your business plan**, written so it **naturally follows the Executive Summary** and avoids repeating the same information. It also integrates the key aspects you clarified: **two-wheeler focus, short-distance commuting, driver empowerment, leasing partnerships, and the HerWay brand**.

Company Description

HerWay is a technology-enabled mobility startup focused on providing **safe, reliable, and accessible ride-hailing services exclusively for women**. The company's primary service model centers on **two-wheeler ride-hailing**, allowing women passengers to travel short distances efficiently while creating flexible employment opportunities for women drivers.

The platform is designed to address two major challenges in urban transportation: safety concerns for women commuters and limited access to sustainable earning opportunities for women in low-wage occupations. Through a mobile application, HerWay connects female passengers with trained female drivers, creating a trusted mobility network that prioritizes safety, affordability, and accessibility.

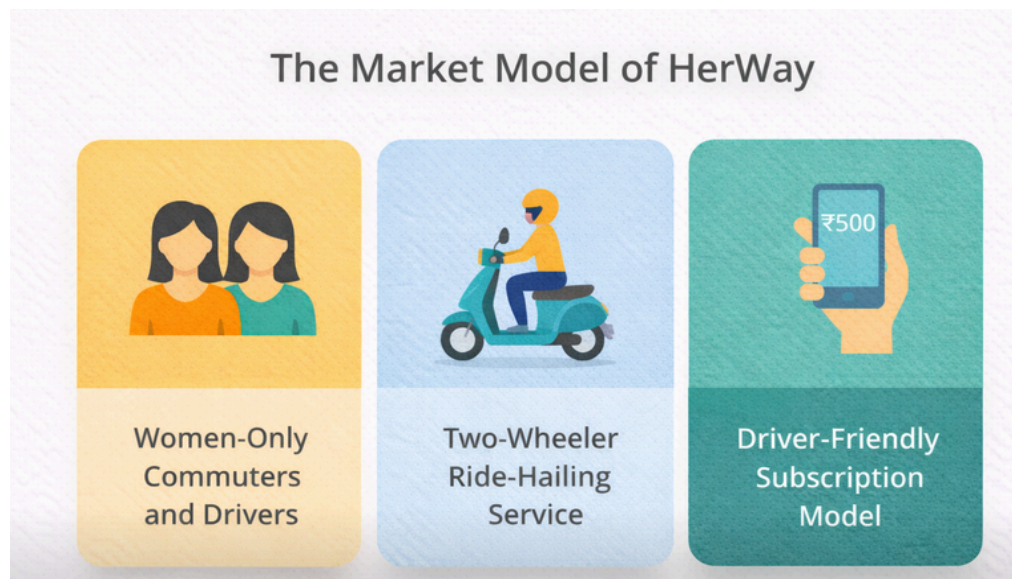
HerWay will initially focus on **high-frequency short-distance routes**, particularly areas where daily commuting demand is concentrated. In metropolitan cities such as Mumbai, this includes routes connecting residential neighborhoods to railway stations, bus terminals, and commercial

hubs. By targeting these high-demand transit corridors, the company aims to establish strong early adoption while ensuring operational efficiency.

Mission Statement

The mission of HerWay is to create a safe and empowering urban mobility ecosystem where women can travel confidently and access dignified, flexible employment opportunities through inclusive transportation services.

Market Model



Vision Statement

HerWay envisions becoming a leading women-first mobility platform that transforms urban transportation by integrating safety, accessibility, and economic empowerment. In the long term, the company aims to expand across multiple urban centers while increasing women's participation in the mobility workforce.

Core Values

HerWay's operations are guided by the following principles:

- **Safety First:** Ensuring secure travel experiences for women passengers and drivers through verified onboarding and transparent ride systems.
- **Empowerment:** Enabling women to access flexible income opportunities and greater financial independence.
- **Fairness and Transparency:** Implementing ethical business practices that allow drivers to retain the majority of their earnings.
- **Accessibility:** Providing affordable and convenient mobility solutions for short-distance urban travel.
- **Community Impact:** Contributing to safer cities and more inclusive economic participation for women.

Industry and Market Position

HerWay operates within the rapidly growing **urban mobility and ride-hailing industry**, which has expanded significantly due to increasing smartphone adoption and demand for convenient transportation solutions. However, existing platforms largely focus on scale and efficiency rather than gender-specific safety and employment inclusion.

HerWay positions itself as a **specialized mobility platform designed specifically for women**, focusing on short-distance two-wheeler rides. By concentrating on high-frequency commuting routes and community-based deployment, the company differentiates itself from large-scale ride-hailing platforms while addressing an underserved market segment.

Target Market

HerWay serves two primary customer groups: women passengers and women drivers.

Women Passengers

The platform targets women who require safe and reliable transportation for daily commuting. These include students, working professionals, and urban residents who frequently travel short distances between residential areas, workplaces, and public transit stations.

Women Drivers

HerWay also targets women seeking flexible and better-paying employment opportunities. Many women currently employed in informal or low-wage roles—such as domestic work, cleaning services, or security positions, possess basic two-wheeler riding skills but lack structured opportunities to convert these skills into income. HerWay aims to support these women through training programs and platform access.

Competitive Advantages

HerWay offers several key advantages compared to traditional ride-hailing services.

First, the platform operates as a **women-only mobility ecosystem**, creating a safer environment for passengers and drivers alike.

Second, the company focuses on **two-wheeler ride-hailing**, which enables faster travel through congested urban areas and reduces entry barriers for drivers.

Third, HerWay introduces an **ethical revenue model** in which drivers pay a small platform access fee rather than high commission charges, allowing them to retain the full value of their ride earnings.

Finally, the company plans to collaborate with vehicle manufacturers and financing partners to provide **two-wheeler leasing opportunities**, enabling women to access vehicles without significant upfront investment.

Legal Structure

HerWay will operate as a **private limited company**, a structure that allows for operational flexibility, investor participation, and scalable growth. This structure also enables the company to establish partnerships with vehicle manufacturers, financial institutions, and social organizations supporting women's employment.

Business Goals

Short-Term Goals

- Launch a pilot program in selected high-demand commuting zones
- Establish partnerships with driving training centers and vehicle leasing providers

- Onboard the first group of trained women drivers
- Build a trusted customer base within closed communities and transit hubs

Long-Term Goals

- Expand operations to multiple neighborhoods and transit corridors within major cities
- Increase driver participation and employment opportunities for women
- Develop advanced safety and route optimization features within the platform
- Establish HerWay as a leading women-first mobility network in urban transportation

Market Analysis

Industry Overview

The ride-hailing and shared mobility industry in India has experienced rapid growth due to increasing urbanization, smartphone penetration, and demand for convenient short-distance transportation. Platforms such as Uber, Ola, and Rapido have significantly expanded the accessibility of on-demand transport services, particularly in metropolitan areas. However, these platforms largely operate with a mixed-gender driver base and primarily focus on large-scale transportation coverage rather than addressing specific safety concerns of women commuters.

Safety remains one of the most frequently cited concerns among women using ride-hailing services. Many women prefer short-distance transport options that offer greater trust and comfort, especially when traveling alone or during early morning and late evening hours. At the same time, a large segment of women in urban areas are engaged in low-wage occupations with limited opportunities for financial mobility. These conditions create a strong opportunity for a women-focused mobility platform that improves commuting safety while generating new employment opportunities.

HerWay operates within this expanding mobility ecosystem but differentiates itself by focusing on **two-wheeler ride-hailing services for women**, particularly for short-distance and last-mile transportation needs.

Target Market and Customer Segments

HerWay serves two primary customer groups: women passengers and women drivers.

Women Passengers

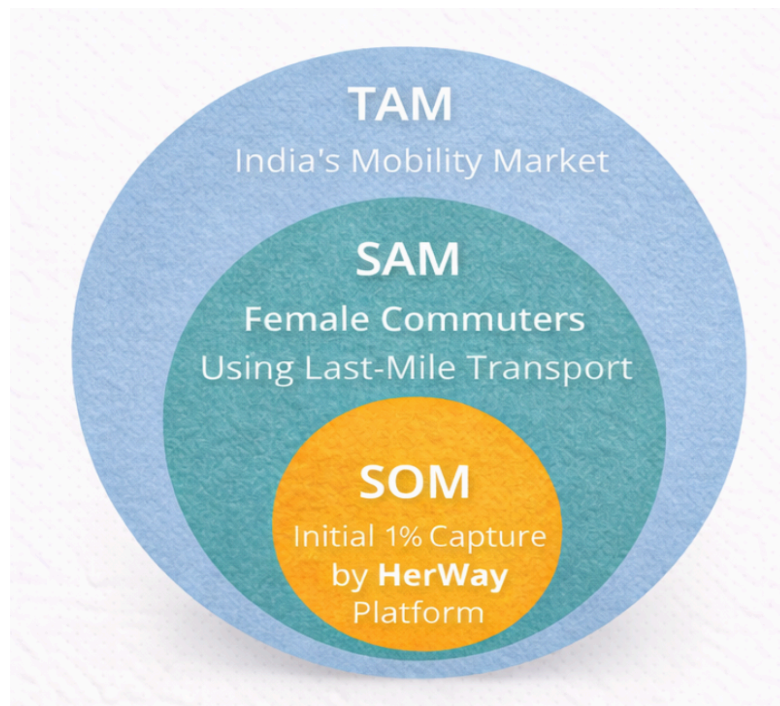
The primary users of the platform include women who require safe and reliable short-distance transportation. This group includes students, working professionals, and urban residents commuting between residential areas, railway stations, bus stops, and workplaces. In cities such as Mumbai, where daily commuting heavily relies on public transportation, the demand for efficient last-mile connectivity is particularly high.

Women Drivers

The second segment includes women seeking flexible employment opportunities. Many women currently working as domestic workers, security staff, or cleaning personnel already possess basic two-wheeler riding skills but lack access to structured employment opportunities in the mobility sector. By offering training, licensing support, and vehicle leasing options, HerWay aims to enable these women to transition into more flexible and potentially higher-paying work.

Market Size and Growth Potential

The market opportunity for HerWay can be understood through the **Total Addressable Market (TAM)**, **Serviceable Available Market (SAM)**, and **Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)** framework.



In the long term, capturing even 5–10% of this market would represent a significant mobility opportunity.

This phased approach allows the company to begin with focused urban corridors such as residential areas connected to railway stations and expand gradually as demand and driver supply grow.

Market Trends

Several trends support the growth potential of HerWay's business model:

- Increasing awareness of women's safety in public spaces
- Growing participation of women in the workforce and education
- Rising demand for last-mile mobility solutions in dense urban areas
- Expansion of two-wheeler ride-hailing services due to lower cost and faster travel in congested cities

These trends indicate strong long-term potential for gender-focused mobility services.

Competitive Landscape

The current ride-hailing market is dominated by large platforms such as Uber, Ola, and Rapido. These companies provide extensive transportation coverage and established digital infrastructure. However, their services primarily focus on scale and efficiency rather than gender-specific safety and employment inclusion.

Additionally, most existing platforms operate on commission-based models where drivers pay a percentage of each ride to the platform. This can reduce driver earnings and create dissatisfaction among drivers.

HerWay enters the market with a differentiated approach that focuses specifically on women commuters and women drivers.

Competitive Advantage and Unique Selling Proposition

HerWay's competitive advantage lies in its integrated approach to safety, accessibility, and employment.

First, the platform operates as a **women-only ride-hailing ecosystem**, creating a safer environment for both passengers and drivers.

Second, the company focuses on **two-wheeler mobility**, which is particularly suited for short-distance urban travel and allows faster movement through congested city environments.

Third, HerWay introduces a **driver-first revenue model** in which drivers pay a small platform access fee rather than per-ride commissions. This ensures that drivers retain 100% of their ride earnings.

Finally, the company plans to collaborate with vehicle manufacturers and financial institutions to provide **two-wheeler leasing programs**, enabling women to access vehicles without high upfront investment.

Together, these factors position HerWay as a specialized mobility solution designed to address both urban transportation challenges and economic empowerment for women.

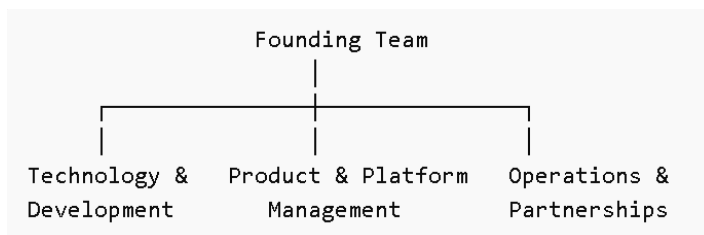
Organization and Management

Organizational Structure

HerWay will operate as a technology-driven mobility startup with a lean organizational structure in its early stages. The company will initially be led by a three-member founding team responsible for product development, operational planning, and strategic growth. As the platform scales, additional operational teams will be introduced to support driver onboarding, customer support, partnerships, and technology maintenance.

The initial organizational structure is designed to ensure efficient decision-making, strong technical execution, and effective coordination between product development and platform operations.

Initial Organizational Structure



As the business grows, the company plans to expand its structure by introducing departments such as Driver Support, Marketing, and Customer Experience.

Founding Team

HerWay is founded by three technology-focused entrepreneurs currently pursuing a Bachelor of Technology degree in Computer Science. Their technical background allows them to design, develop, and manage the digital platform required for the mobility service while also understanding the technological infrastructure needed for scalable ride-hailing solutions.

RHYTHM SINGHAL – Co-Founder & Chief Product Officer

Rhythm Singhal will be responsible for overseeing product strategy and user experience design for the HerWay platform. Her role includes defining the product vision, ensuring that the mobile application provides a safe and intuitive experience for both passengers and drivers, and managing the development of new platform features.

With a background in computer science and experience working with digital product design tools, Rhythm will focus on translating user needs into functional product features. She will also oversee research related to customer feedback, platform usability, and safety-focused system design.

Key responsibilities include:

- Designing the platform's user experience and interface
- Defining product development priorities
- Integrating safety features such as ride tracking and verification systems
- Analyzing user feedback to improve platform functionality

YASHWARDHAN SINGH – Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer

Yashwardhan Singh will lead the technical development and infrastructure of the HerWay platform. His role involves designing and managing the core technology architecture required for the ride-hailing application, including ride-matching systems, location services, and backend data management.

As Chief Technology Officer, he will ensure the platform remains reliable, scalable, and secure while supporting future growth in user numbers and ride volume.

Key responsibilities include:

- Developing the mobile and backend platform architecture

- Implementing ride-matching algorithms and route optimization
- Managing database systems and platform security
- Overseeing system scalability and technical maintenance

PRATHAMESH BHANDARE – Co-Founder & Head of Operations and Partnerships

Prathamesh Bhandare will oversee the operational and partnership aspects of the business. His role focuses on driver onboarding, partnerships with training institutions and vehicle providers, and managing the day-to-day functioning of the platform's driver ecosystem.

He will also lead collaboration efforts with NGOs, driving training centers, and vehicle leasing partners to ensure that women drivers can access affordable vehicles and proper training before joining the platform.

Key responsibilities include:

- Managing driver recruitment and onboarding processes
- Building partnerships with vehicle manufacturers and leasing providers
- Coordinating driver training and licensing support programs
- Overseeing operational logistics and platform compliance

Advisory and Partnership Network

During the early stages, HerWay will rely on external partnerships rather than a formal board of directors. The company plans to collaborate with:

- Driving training institutes to provide skill development for women drivers
- Non-governmental organizations (NGOs) focused on women's employment and empowerment
- Vehicle manufacturers and financing institutions offering two-wheeler leasing programs
- Safety consultants to improve platform security and driver verification processes

These partnerships will provide industry expertise, operational support, and community outreach necessary for scaling the platform.

Management Approach

The founding team will adopt a collaborative management approach where strategic decisions are made collectively while operational responsibilities remain clearly defined. This structure enables efficient coordination between technology development, operational execution, and partnership building.

As HerWay grows, the company will gradually introduce specialized teams for customer support, marketing, driver relations, and technical maintenance to ensure sustainable expansion.

Service or Product Line

Overview of the Service

HerWay provides a **women-only ride-hailing platform** designed to offer safe, reliable, and affordable short-distance transportation. The service connects female passengers with trained female drivers through a mobile application that enables real-time ride booking, ride tracking, and secure payment options.

Unlike many traditional ride-hailing platforms that rely primarily on four-wheeler vehicles, HerWay focuses on **two-wheeler ride services**. Two-wheelers are well suited for short-distance travel in densely populated urban environments where traffic congestion is common. This model also reduces operational costs and lowers entry barriers for potential drivers, as many women already possess basic riding skills.

The platform primarily serves **last-mile and short-distance commuting needs**, such as travel between residential areas and major transit hubs including railway stations, bus stops, and commercial centers. By concentrating on high-frequency commuting routes, HerWay aims to ensure efficient operations while building a consistent user base.

Service Offering

The HerWay platform provides several key services designed to address both mobility needs and employment opportunities.

Women-Only Ride Services

HerWay enables female passengers to book rides exclusively with female drivers, creating a safer and more comfortable transportation environment. The platform includes features such as

driver verification, live ride tracking, and passenger feedback systems to enhance accountability and user trust.

Two-Wheeler Mobility

The service focuses on two-wheeler transportation, which allows faster navigation through congested urban traffic and offers a cost-effective ride option for short distances. This format also makes the service more accessible to drivers who may already have experience riding motorcycles or scooters.

Driver Training and Onboarding

To ensure safety and professionalism, HerWay plans to provide structured onboarding support for new drivers. This includes partnerships with driving training institutes that can help women develop the skills necessary to operate two-wheelers safely and professionally.

Training programs will also guide drivers through licensing requirements, safety protocols, and customer interaction standards.

Vehicle Leasing Support

One of the major barriers preventing women from entering the mobility workforce is the cost of purchasing a vehicle. To address this challenge, HerWay plans to collaborate with vehicle manufacturers and financing institutions to offer **two-wheeler leasing options**.

Through this model, drivers can access vehicles on an affordable lease basis rather than making a large upfront purchase. This approach allows new drivers to start earning income while gradually covering vehicle costs through their work.

Product Development and Platform Features

The HerWay service will operate through a mobile application designed for both passengers and drivers.

Key platform features include:

- Ride booking and driver matching system
- Real-time location tracking and ride monitoring
- Verified driver profiles and safety checks
- Secure digital payment integration
- Ride history and feedback system

The product development cycle will involve continuous improvement based on user feedback, data analytics, and operational insights. As the platform grows, additional features such as route optimization, emergency assistance tools, and driver performance analytics may be introduced.

Intellectual Property

HerWay's intellectual property primarily lies in its **digital platform, brand identity, and operational model**. The company will develop proprietary mobile applications and backend systems that enable ride matching, driver management, and secure user interactions.

The HerWay brand name, logo, and platform interface will be protected through trademark registration where applicable. In addition, the company's operational processes—particularly the integration of driver training, leasing partnerships, and subscription-based driver economics—represent strategic intellectual assets that differentiate the platform within the ride-hailing market.

Pricing Strategy

HerWay adopts a **driver-first pricing model** designed to ensure fair earnings while maintaining affordability for passengers.

Unlike traditional ride-hailing platforms that charge drivers a commission on each ride, HerWay will operate on a **subscription-based platform access model**. Drivers will pay a modest access fee of ₹500 or complete a minimum threshold of rides (for example, 30 rides) to maintain active access to the platform.

Key aspects of the pricing strategy include:

- Drivers retain **100% of ride earnings**
- No commission is deducted from individual rides
- Subscription model ensures predictable revenue for the platform
- Short-distance rides are priced competitively to remain affordable for passengers

This approach supports long-term driver retention while maintaining transparency in earnings.

Cost Structure

The primary costs associated with delivering the HerWay service include:

- Mobile application development and maintenance
- Driver onboarding and verification processes
- Training partnerships with driving institutes
- Marketing and community outreach initiatives
- Operational and customer support infrastructure

Because HerWay operates as a **digital platform rather than owning vehicles directly**, capital expenditure remains relatively low. The use of leasing partnerships further reduces financial barriers for drivers while allowing the platform to scale more efficiently.

Marketing and Sales Strategy

Marketing Approach

HerWay's marketing strategy focuses on **community-based growth and hyperlocal demand generation** rather than large-scale advertising in the early stages. Because the platform targets daily short-distance commuting, the initial marketing efforts will concentrate on **high-frequency transit zones**, such as areas surrounding railway stations, bus stops, and residential neighborhoods with heavy commuter traffic.

The strategy prioritizes building **trust within communities** by promoting the platform as a safe, women-driven mobility service while simultaneously highlighting the economic empowerment opportunities it offers to women drivers. By positioning the brand around safety, accessibility, and empowerment, HerWay aims to create strong emotional and practical value for its users.

Customer Acquisition Strategy

HerWay will adopt a **two-sided acquisition strategy**, targeting both passengers and drivers simultaneously.

Passenger Acquisition

To attract female riders, the company will focus on locations with concentrated daily commuting activity. Key initiatives include:

- Awareness campaigns near railway stations, bus stops, and commercial areas where last-mile connectivity is in high demand
- Collaboration with residential communities and educational institutions to introduce the service as a safer commuting alternative

- Digital outreach through social media platforms emphasizing safety, convenience, and affordability

These efforts will allow the company to reach potential riders who already rely on short-distance transport services as part of their daily routine.

Driver Acquisition

Driver onboarding will focus on women currently working in low-wage and physically demanding jobs, such as domestic work, cleaning services, and security roles. HerWay will collaborate with driving training institutes, NGOs, and community organizations to identify women interested in transitioning into mobility-based work.

Driver acquisition initiatives will include:

- Information sessions and recruitment drives within residential communities
- Partnerships with training centers offering two-wheeler riding instruction and licensing support
- Collaboration with vehicle manufacturers and financing partners to provide affordable two-wheeler leasing options

This structured onboarding approach helps ensure a reliable and growing driver network while supporting women's workforce participation.

Sales Process and Service Methodology

HerWay operates through a **digital platform-based sales model**, where ride transactions occur directly through the mobile application. The sales process begins when a passenger books a ride through the app, after which the platform matches the passenger with the nearest available driver.

The platform's sales methodology emphasizes **high ride frequency rather than high ticket value**, as the service focuses on short-distance transportation. By targeting routes with consistent daily demand, such as residential areas connected to transit hubs, HerWay aims to generate recurring usage from regular commuters.

For drivers, the platform operates on a **subscription-based participation model**, where drivers pay a small access fee rather than commission on each ride. This system encourages driver loyalty while simplifying earnings management.

Customer Retention Strategy

Customer retention is critical in mobility services where daily commuting habits often determine long-term platform usage. HerWay will focus on creating a reliable and trusted experience that encourages repeat usage.

Retention strategies include:

- Consistent driver verification and safety protocols
- User-friendly ride booking and tracking features
- Incentive programs that reward frequent riders
- Transparent feedback and rating systems that maintain service quality

For drivers, retention will be supported through a fair earnings model, flexible working hours, and access to vehicle leasing programs that reduce financial barriers.

Distribution Channels

HerWay's service will be distributed primarily through its **mobile application platform**, which will serve as the central interface for ride bookings, driver management, and payment processing.

In addition to the digital platform, the company will utilize **offline community outreach channels** to expand awareness and adoption. These include partnerships with:

- Driving training institutes
- Women's support organizations and NGOs
- Residential community associations
- Educational institutions and workplace clusters

These partnerships allow HerWay to reach both passengers and drivers within trusted community networks.

Advertising and Promotional Strategy

HerWay's promotional strategy will focus on **targeted, high-impact marketing activities** rather than large-scale media spending during the early stages.

Key promotional initiatives include:

- Community outreach campaigns in high-traffic commuter areas
- Social media storytelling that highlights women drivers and empowerment narratives
- Referral programs encouraging riders and drivers to invite others to the platform
- Local events and demonstrations that introduce the service within residential neighborhoods and campuses

These promotional efforts are designed to create organic growth by building awareness, trust, and long-term engagement within the communities the platform serves.

Funding Request

HerWay seeks initial funding to support the development, launch, and early-stage expansion of the platform. The primary objective of this funding is to establish the technological infrastructure, onboard drivers, and build partnerships that enable the service to operate efficiently in selected urban locations.

Funding Requirement

The company is seeking **₹50 lakh in initial seed funding** to support the pilot launch and early operational phase.

Use of Funds

The requested funds will be allocated across the following areas:

- **Technology Development (30%)**
Development of the mobile application, backend infrastructure, ride-matching systems, and platform security.
- **Driver Training and Onboarding (20%)**
Partnerships with driving training institutes, driver verification, and onboarding programs.
- **Marketing and Community Outreach (20%)**
Awareness campaigns in transit hubs, residential communities, and digital marketing initiatives.
- **Operational Costs (20%)**
Customer support systems, administrative operations, and early-stage management expenses.
- **Partnership Development (10%)**
Establishing collaborations with vehicle manufacturers and financing partners for two-wheeler leasing programs.

Preferred Funding Type

HerWay is open to **equity-based seed investment**, where investors receive ownership shares in the company in exchange for capital. This approach enables the company to secure funding without early debt obligations while allowing investors to participate in long-term growth.

Future Funding Requirements (3–5 Years)

As the platform expands to additional urban markets, HerWay may seek additional investment to support scaling efforts. Future funding rounds will primarily focus on:

- Expanding operations to multiple cities
- Enhancing platform technology and safety systems
- Increasing driver recruitment and training programs
- Strengthening marketing and brand presence

Long-Term Financial Strategy

HerWay's long-term financial strategy focuses on building a **sustainable, subscription-driven revenue model**. By charging drivers a platform access fee rather than commission on rides, the company aims to maintain predictable recurring revenue while ensuring fair earnings for drivers. As the user base grows, operational efficiency and network effects will contribute to improved profitability.

Financial Projections

Since HerWay is a startup venture, there is currently no historical financial data available. Therefore, the financial projections presented in this business plan are based on estimated market demand, projected driver participation, and expected ride frequency.

The projections assume gradual growth during the first year as the platform launches in selected high-demand commuting areas, followed by expansion into additional zones as driver supply and customer adoption increase.

Revenue Projections

Revenue for HerWay will primarily be generated through the **driver subscription model**, where drivers pay ₹500 per month or maintain a minimum ride threshold to remain active on the platform.

Example projection assumptions:

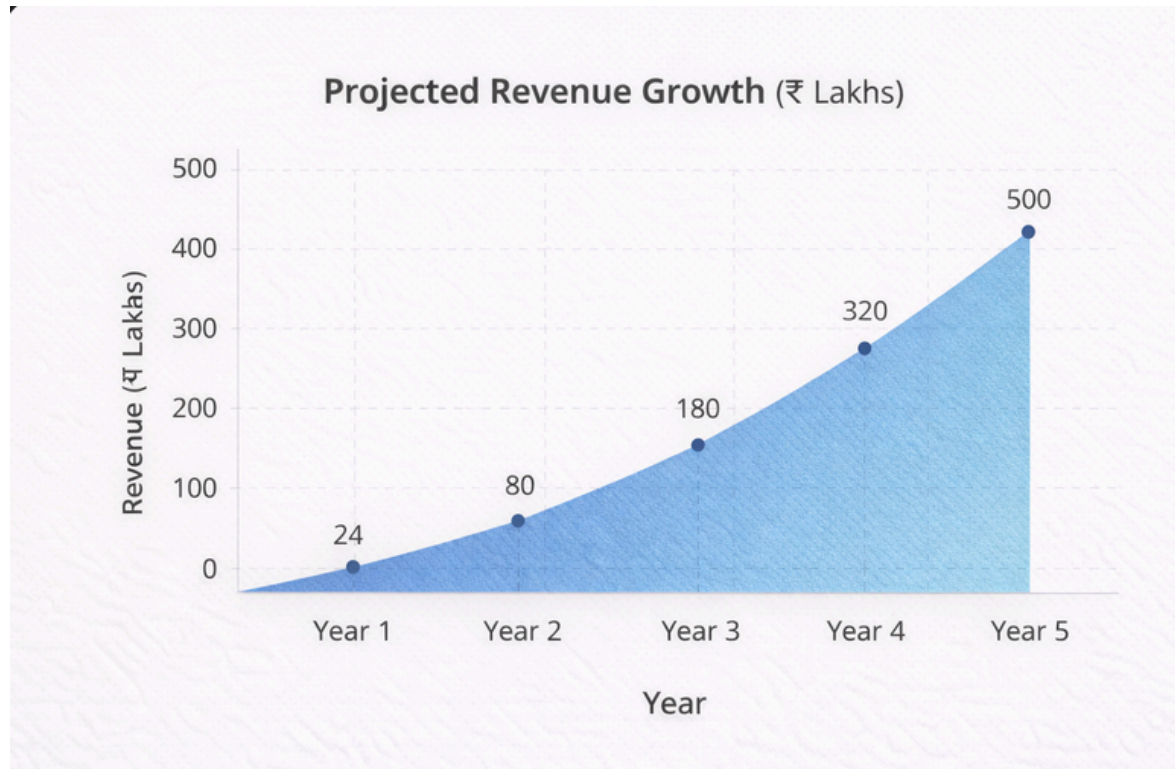
- **Year 1:** Pilot phase with approximately 400 drivers
- **Year 2:** Expansion to multiple neighborhoods with around 1,200 drivers

- **Year 3:** City-wide growth with approximately 3,000 drivers
- **Year 4–5:** Expansion to additional cities and larger driver network

The revenue growth reflects increasing driver participation and rising demand for short-distance mobility services.

Estimated Income Statement (Simplified Projection)

Year	Revenue (₹ Lakhs)	Operating Costs (₹ Lakhs)	Net Profit/Loss (₹ Lakhs)
Year 1	24	40	-16
Year 2	80	60	20
Year 3	180	110	70
Year 4	320	180	140
Year 5	500	260	240



Revenue growth assumes a steady increase in the number of active drivers as the platform expands from pilot zones to city-wide operations.

During the initial year, the company may operate at a loss due to development and marketing investments. However, as the platform scales and driver participation increases, revenue growth is expected to exceed operational costs.

Break-Even Analysis

The break-even point represents the stage at which total revenue equals total operational costs. Based on projected expenses and driver subscription revenue, HerWay is expected to reach break-even during **Year 2 of operations**, once the platform reaches a stable driver base and recurring subscription revenue.

The financial projections are based on the following assumptions:

- Steady growth in driver onboarding through training and leasing partnerships
- Increasing adoption among women commuters seeking safer travel options
- Expansion across high-demand commuting routes near transit hubs
- Stable operating costs due to the platform-based business model

These assumptions are aligned with the company's phased growth strategy and targeted expansion approach.

Appendix

The appendix section provides supporting materials and supplementary information that strengthen the credibility of the HerWay business plan. These documents offer additional details regarding the research, operational model, and founding team that support the feasibility of the proposed venture.

Founding Team Profiles

Rhythm Singhal

Co-Founder & Chief Product Officer

Rhythm Singhal is currently pursuing a Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science. Her role focuses on product development, user experience design, and ensuring that the HerWay mobile platform provides a safe and intuitive interface for both drivers and passengers. She contributes to platform design, feature development, and customer feedback analysis.

Yashwardhan Singh

Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer

Yashwardhan Singh is a Computer Science student responsible for the technical development and infrastructure of the HerWay platform. His responsibilities include backend architecture, ride-matching algorithms, platform security, and system scalability to ensure that the application operates efficiently as user demand grows.

Prathamesh Bhandare

Co-Founder & Head of Operations and Partnerships

Prathamesh Bhandare manages operational planning and partnership development. His responsibilities include driver onboarding, coordination with training institutions, and establishing partnerships with vehicle manufacturers and leasing providers to support women drivers entering the mobility workforce.

Market Research Summary

Preliminary research for HerWay included surveys and interviews conducted with women commuters and women employed in low-wage occupations such as domestic work, security services, and cleaning roles.

Key insights from this research include:

- Safety is the primary concern influencing women's transportation choices.
- Many women expressed discomfort using ride-hailing services with unfamiliar male drivers.
- Several women indicated interest in flexible employment opportunities within the mobility sector.
- Two-wheeler ride services were perceived as a convenient and affordable option for short-distance travel.

These findings helped validate the concept of a women-only mobility platform focusing on short-distance transportation.

Market Size Data

The market opportunity for HerWay is based on publicly available mobility industry estimates and urban commuting patterns.

- India's shared mobility market is projected to reach approximately **USD 21.1 billion by 2030**.
- In cities such as Mumbai, millions of commuters rely on public transport systems daily, creating strong demand for last-mile connectivity services.
- Female commuters represent a significant portion of daily transit users, indicating a large potential market for women-focused mobility services.

These figures support the viability of a specialized ride-hailing service designed specifically for women.

Technical Overview of the Platform

The HerWay platform will operate through a mobile application that connects passengers and drivers through real-time ride matching.

Key platform components include:

- Ride booking and location-based driver matching
- Real-time GPS tracking and ride monitoring
- Verified driver onboarding and safety checks
- Secure payment integration
- Ride history and feedback system

The platform architecture will be designed to support scalable growth as the user base expands.

Driver Training and Vehicle Leasing Framework

To enable women to join the mobility workforce, HerWay plans to establish partnerships with:

- Driving training institutes that provide two-wheeler training and licensing support
- NGOs and community organizations supporting women's employment
- Vehicle manufacturers and financial institutions that can offer two-wheeler leasing options

This framework allows women drivers to access vehicles and training without significant upfront investment.